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IT'S A NEW YEAR, a time for new beginnings and like several other people you probably have a list of resolutions a mile long too. Everything from being more productive at work to hiking to the Mount Everest base camp is perhaps part of that list, neatly written and stuck to the refrigerator at home or pinned to the desk at office. Research shows that one of the top things on the resolution list is 'becoming healthier'. And so in the first week of January, after all the excesses of the holiday season, we suddenly decide to detox, diet, work out, meditate, and do a hundred other things to 'become healthier'. Three to four weeks later, we are back to our usual self and it's all the same till it's time to write another New Year resolution.

"It's because we give ourselves unattainable goals that then become a task. A better way of doing it is to fix habits," says Kavita Devgan, nutritionist and author of books such as *The Don't Diet Plan* and *The Immunity Diet*.

"Do an audit and pinpoint three problem areas—it could be processed foods, too many sweets, or several cups of tea/coffee. Just cut it down to 50 per cent of your consumption. Don't try and do a cold turkey because that never works," she suggests. Also, it's important to do it for the whole year and not just for a month; therefore small steps



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count. "It's the best way to detox. Instead of tall claims make these small changes," she says.

Agrees Luke Coutinho, the Founder of Luke Coutinho Holistic Healing Systems and author of books such as *Small Wins Everyday*: "It's never about the New Year resolutions. We focus on the small wins. Make small wins around the big changes that you want till it becomes a lifestyle and a habit," he suggests.

Coutinho says when we give ourselves small tasks and succeed at them our brain recognises the dopamine, the reward molecule. "Then you will want to win more and more. But if you make a big goal

and you fail, the brain wants to protect you from that feeling of failure so it will find ways for you not to do it again."

He believes that it is very important to write down your goals. "What is my goal and what are the top three smallest actions I need to take? Write it all down," Coutinho says. When it comes to small wins, every step counts. "It could be as little as getting one meal right, or eating on time or intermittent fasting. Small goals and small wins is the way to go," says Coutinho.

So now that we have established that the only way to stick to New Year resolutions is to make small changes in our lifestyle which are